

STONEFLIES

Members of the order Plecoptera are soft, slender-bodied insects with a pair of thin tail filaments and two pairs of wings. The nymphal stages are aquatic.



PERLA BIPUNCTATA
F: Perlidae

The males of this species, which favours stony streams in upland regions, have much shorter wings and can be half the size of the females.



YELLOW SALLY
Isoperla grammata
F: Perlodidae

Particularly common in limestone areas, this species prefers clean, gravel-bottomed streams and stony lakes. Males are shorter than females.

STICK AND LEAF INSECTS

These slow-moving herbivorous insects of the order Pseudophasmatidae have a stick- or leaf-like body that may be smooth or spiny. Many are well camouflaged to avoid predators.

TWO-STRIPED STICK INSECT
Anisomorpha buprestoides
F: Pseudophasmatidae
Found in the S. USA, this species can eject an acidic, defensive liquid from glands in the thorax.

4.2–6.8 cm
1½–2½ in



JUNGLE NYMPH STICK INSECT
Heteropteryx dilatata
F: Heteropterygidae

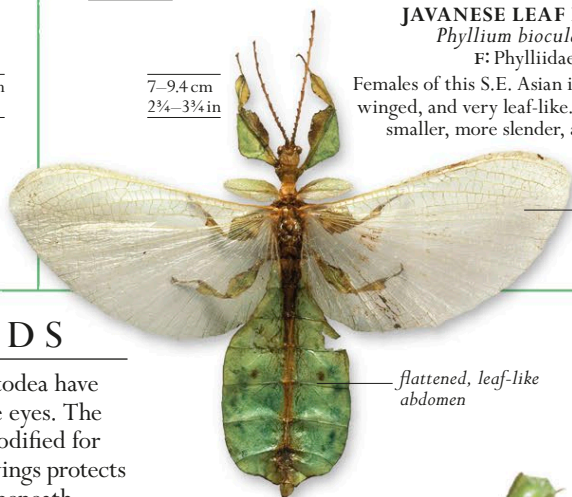
This impressive species is found in Malaysia. Females are flightless and green; males are smaller, winged, and brownish.



10–15.5 cm
4–6 in

JAVANESE LEAF INSECT
Phyllium bioculatum
F: Phylliidae

Females of this S.E. Asian insect are large, winged, and very leaf-like. The males are smaller, more slender, and brown.



large,
fan-shaped
hindwing

flattened, leaf-like
abdomen

leaf-like front wing

large compound eyes on a
triangular head

extended prothorax

spiny, enlarged
front femur

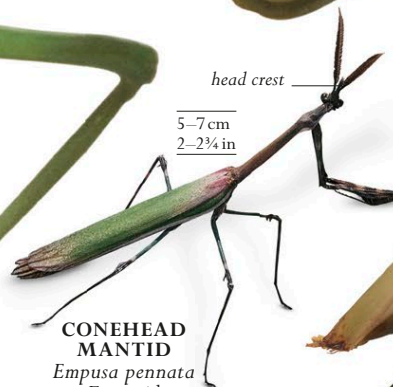
head crest

COMMON PRAYING MANTIS
Mantis religiosa
F: Mantidae

The strike of a praying mantis lasts a fraction of a second, and impales the prey on the sharp spines of the front legs.

CONEHEAD MANTID
Empusa pennata
F: Empusidae

A slender mantid with a distinctive head crest, this S. European species eats small flies and can be green or brown.



5–7 cm
2–2¾ in

ORCHID MANTIS
Hymenopus coronatus
F: Hymenopodidae

With its flower-mimicking colour and legs resembling petals, this S.E. Asian mantis is able to hide among foliage and ambush small insects.



3–7 cm
1¼–2¾ in

EARWIGS

These slender, slightly flattened, scavenging insects belong to the order Dermaptera. They have short front wings with large fan-shaped hindwings folded beneath. The flexible abdomen ends in a pair of multipurpose forceps.



1.2–1.5 cm
½–¾ in

COMMON EARWIG
Forficula auricularia
F: Forficulidae

This species can be found under bark and in leaf litter. The female cares for her eggs and feeds the young nymphs.



1.6–3 cm
½–1¼ in

TAWNY EARWIG
Labidura riparia
F: Labiduridae

The tawny earwig, the largest European species, is especially common along sandy river banks and in coastal areas.